Love Poem Medley

By Rudy Francisco

To the Girl Who Works at Starbucks, Down the Street from My House on Del Mar Heights Road, I Swear to God I'm Not a Stalker (Pg 21)

When I asked you for a chai latte,
what I meant to say was:
"I was walking past. I saw you in the window.
I only came in here because I had to know
what your voice sounded like."
But instead of saying that, I got really nervous
and just ordered the first thing on the menu.
I don't even know what "chai" is.

Or a latte, for that matter.

I imagine, when God made you,
he cussed for the first time. He turned to an angel,
gave him a high five and said: "Goddamn, I'm good!"
You are that beautiful. I spent the last five days
trying to figure out how I'm going introduce myself

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to you properly, and I think I've finally figured it out.
It's going be something like… "Hi."

That's all I got so far, but I think it's a good start.

INTRODUCTION

Ah, love. The elusive and ephemeral chemical experience that all humans want and crave. It's so powerful that it can be hard to describe. Let's face it: you don't want to trip over your words when you're trying to convey to someone just how much affection you have for them. Love is taking a risk; but the risk is always, always worth it. In fact, a Chinese proverb describes love in this way: "Being deeply loved by someone give you strength, while loving someone deeply gives you courage." So here's a bit of courage . . .

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Correctly (Pg 17)

. . . I want you to come to me like an afternoon, come to me slowly as if you were a broken sunset with a lazy sky on your shoulders. If you let me be your sunlight, I promise that I will penetrate your darkness until you speak in angel wings. Pull me close to you, tell me that you love me, and then scratch your future into my back so I can be

everything that you live for. I promise that I will love you as
if it's the only thing that I've ever done correctly.

If I Was a Love Poet (Pg 23-24)

I'll be honest, I'm usually not really a love poet.
In fact, every time I try to write about love, my hands
    cramp
just to show me how painful love can be and sometimes,
pencils break just to prove that every now and then,
love takes a little more work than planned.
I'm not much of a love poet. But if I was to wake up
tomorrow morning and decide that I really wanted
to write about love, my first poem would be about you.
    About how
I loved you the same way that I learned how to ride a bike.
Scared, but reckless. With no training wheels or elbow pads
so my scars can tell the story of how I fell for you.

I'm not much of a love poet, but if I was, I'd write about
    how I see
your face in every cloud and your reflection in every
    window. I've

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written a million poems, hoping that somehow, you'll jump
    out of
the page and be closer to me. Because if you were here
    right now, I
would massage your back until your skin sings songs
that your lips don't even know the words to.
Until your heartbeat sounds like my last name.
And you smile like the Pacific Ocean.
I want to drink the sunlight in your skin.

If I was a love poet, I'd write about how
you have the audacity to be beautiful
even on days when everything around you is ugly.
I'd write about your eyelashes, and how they are like
violin strings that play symphonies every time you blink.

If I was a love poet, I'd write about how I melt in front of
    you
like an ice sculpture every time I hear the vibration in your
    voice.
and whenever I see your name on the caller ID, my heart
    plays

hopscotch inside of my chest. It climbs onto my ribs
like monkey bars, and I feel like a child all over again.

I know that this is going to sound weird, but sometimes,
I pray that God somehow turns you back into one of my ribs
just so that I would never have to spend an entire day
without you.
I swear, I'm usually not a love poet, but if I were to wake up
tomorrow morning and decide that I really wanted to write
about
love, my first poem would be about you.

Again (Pg 25)

Last night, I had a dream. And in this particular dream, I died in my dreams, woke not knowing I was still sleeping, decided to walk. That night, I walked in my sleep, I slept in my walk, I walked backwards until I saw you for the first time, and I could barely muster the courage to introduce myself all over again. You see, I've been trying to find the right words. I've been trying to take the right steps for what seems to me like thousands of years, but something always seems to go wrong between us. We lived in Egypt, I was the

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Pharaoh's slave, you were his daughter. Loving you led to my death, they claimed that I seduced you, and after they stole my life, I was resurrected as a mason. I made the foundation for your house. We met eyes for two seconds, you left, and I didn't see you again until I died. I came back as a caterpillar. I turned into a butterfly, I landed in the palm of your hands, you brushed me away, and the rejection killed me. When I awoke, I was a kick drum, you were a snare, we were both owned by this drummer named Cozy Cole, and when he died, so did we. But I came back just to look for you. I left notes in random places, hoping that you would stumble across them. I carved our names in trees, and then prayed that it would jog your memory. I whispered your name in the wind, hoping somehow, maybe some way, my voice would reach you, but it didn't, and I died. I died early. I died young with breadcrumbs in my hand, so they buried me and when they buried me, they put these coins over my eyes, and I used them as bus fare to get back to Earth, just so I can look for you.

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AWARD HISTORY

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